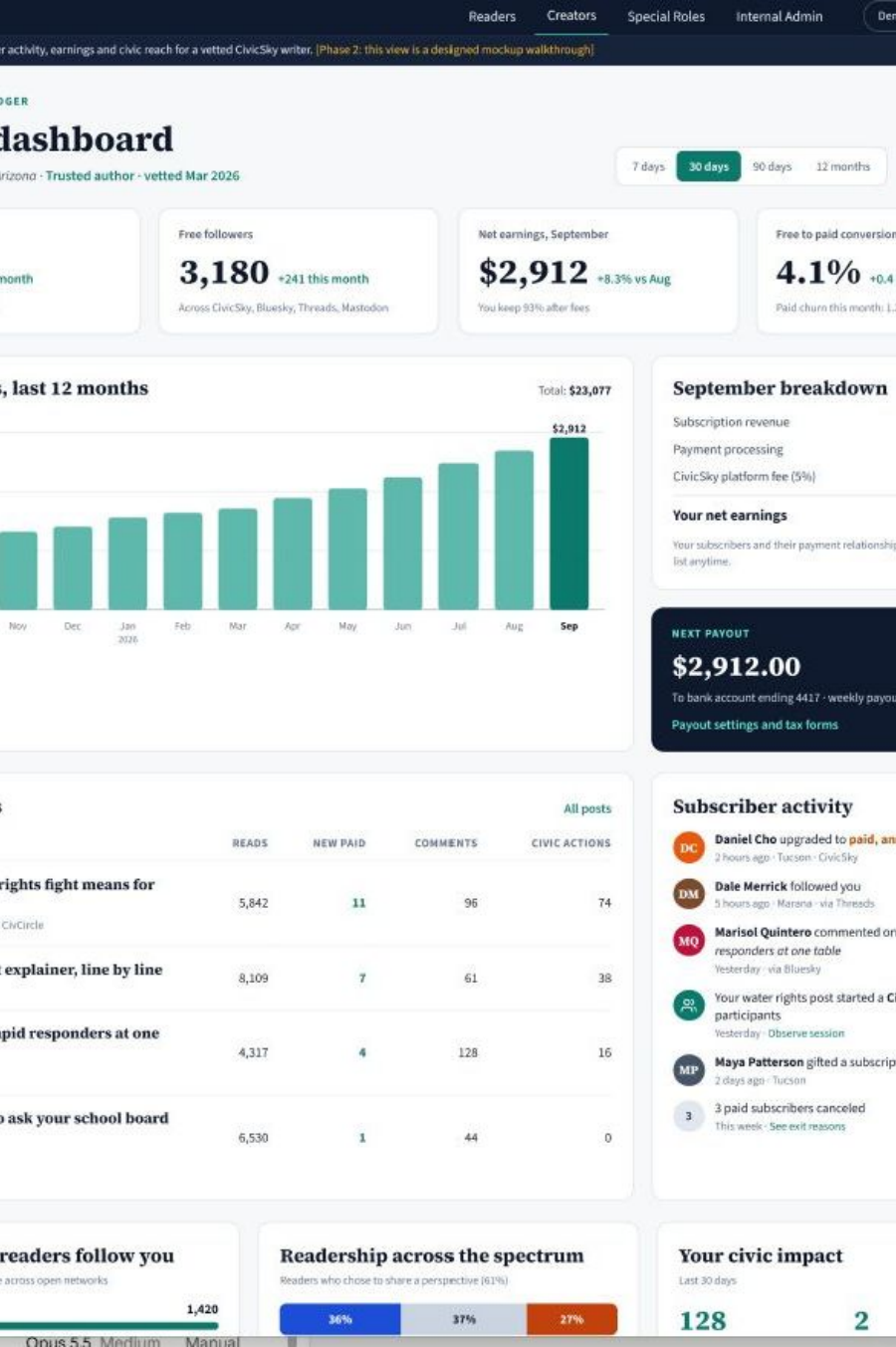


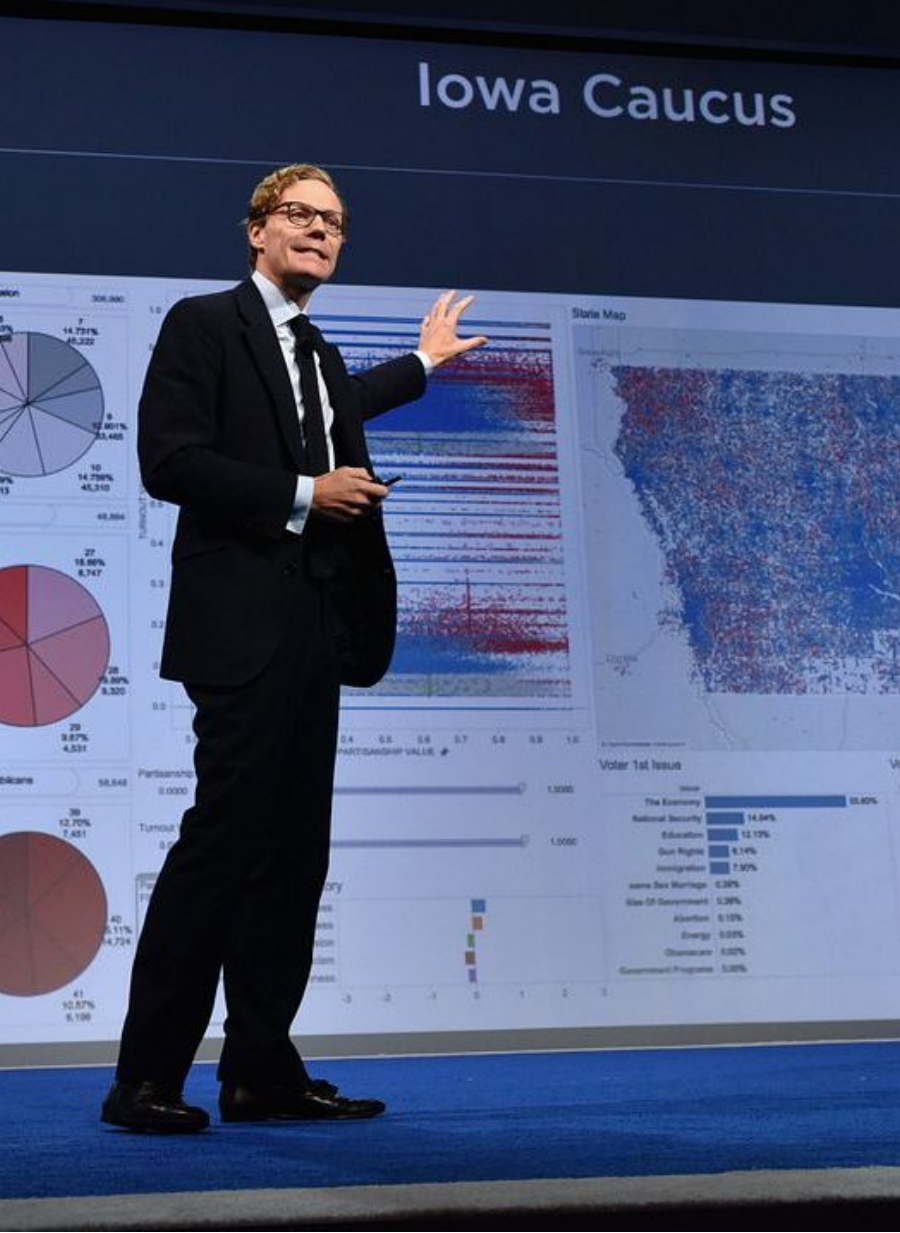
CivicSky

The civic and social layer of the open social web — where trusted writers, neighbors who disagree, and elected officials meet, and where discussion turns into action.

George A. Polisner, Founder / Civic Works / civicsky.civ.works



The Challenge



Polarization Crisis

Political division is now the **2nd biggest concern** for American voters — and rising. The fractures are deepening with each election cycle.

Platforms Profit from Outrage

Engagement-optimized feeds are broken by design. Outrage drives clicks. The incentive structures actively reward division over understanding.

Propaganda at Scale

Bots, troll farms, and low-reliability sources spread faster than corrections. Readers cannot tell who is real or where information originates.

No Connective Tissue

Trusted writers are scattered. Reading, discussing, and taking civic action remain completely disconnected experiences with no bridge between them.

What CivicSky Is

One platform where trusted civic writing, structured deliberation, and verified action converge into a daily habit. Open to everyone — the paywall is on participation quality, never on information.

Read

Short-form social posts alongside paid long-form essays from vetted civic writers — pragmatic left, center, and right. No extremes, no outrage merchants.

Deliberate

CivicCircles — AI-facilitated discussion rooms designed to surface common ground across the political spectrum, not amplify the loudest voices.

Act

Verified civic actions routed directly to officials with the authority to respond — with constituent counts officials can trust, never individual identities.

Three Layers Against Propaganda and Misinformation

Trust is built into the structure — not bolted on afterward. We don't tell people what to think. We show them *who is speaking* and *where information comes from*.

1 Vetted Authors

Every monetizing author is individually vetted. Coverage spans pragmatic left, center, and pragmatic right. No extremes, no conspiracy content, no outrage merchants — by design.

2 Rated Sources

Every shared news link carries independent reliability and bias ratings from third parties such as Ad Fontes Media. CivicSky never rates sources itself — independence is the point.

3 Verified Humans

District verification via **PlaceSpeak**. One person, one verified account, revocable for violations. Officials see aggregate district counts only — never individual identities. \$10/year for free users; included with membership.

DC Daniel Cho shared a story
1 hour ago · Tucson

Worth reading before Tuesday's water board meeting. Good numbers, both sides quoted.

ARIZONA DESERT LEDGER

High reliability | Center

Pima County's groundwater plan, explained: who pays, who pumps, and what changes in 2027

The proposal would cap new agricultural wells and fund recharge basins. Farmers, developers and tribal water officials weigh in.

42 comments 118 shares Discuss in a CivCircle

DM Dale Merrick shared a story
3 hours ago · Marana · via Threads

THE VIRAL REPORT

Low reliability | Lean right

Border towns "overrun" as new policy takes effect

Rated low reliability by 2 of 2 independent raters. Shown with context, not removed. [See other coverage of this story](#)

SOURCE RATING

Arizona Desert Ledger

Rated by 3 independent organizations · CivicSky does not rate sources

Reliability

Ad Fontes Media High
NewsGuard Credible

Bias

Left Center Right
Ad Fontes: center, slight left AllSides: center

Raters agree: reliable reporting, close to center. How each rater scores sources

Same story from across the spectrum

Valley Tribune · Farmers push back on well cap [Lean left](#)

Southwest Wire · Groundwater plan clears first vote [Center](#)

Copper State Journal · Who really pays for recharge [Lean right](#)

Every News Link Carries Its Credentials

When anyone shares a news link on CivicSky, a rating badge is automatically attached — no extra steps required.

Reliability

How factual the outlet is, rated by independent third parties — never CivicSky.

Bias

Where the source sits on the left-to-right spectrum, with full methodology disclosed.

Cross-Spectrum Coverage

Tap any badge for the same story from across the spectrum. Filter bubbles broken by design.

Labeled, Not Censored

Low-reliability links are surfaced and marked — readers decide.

Travels Across Networks

The trust overlay travels with content across federated networks via AT Protocol and ActivityPub.

Near-Zero Infrastructure Cost

Ratings are cached per source. The trust layer adds almost no marginal cost at scale.

Open Protocols, Lean Build

Protocol-Native Independence

CivicSky speaks **AT Protocol** (Bluesky, 46M registered users) and **ActivityPub** (Threads, 400M+ monthly users; Mastodon). Authors own their identity and audience. No single network owns our reach.

Where We Are Now

A prototype is in progress, built with AI-assisted development at near-zero cost. Designed walkthroughs at **civicsky.civ.works** cover the reader experience, paywalled essays, feed card types, CivicCircles deliberation, and the author dashboard.

Next Milestones

Completing the working prototype, author publishing tools, news ratings overlay, district verification, and elected-official account infrastructure.

Market and Competition

The market is proven. Substack: **\$45M ARR, 5M+ paid subscriptions**. Beehiw: **\$30M ARR**. Make.org: **11.9M participants**. US politics is Substack's #1 revenue genre. No one combines all five dimensions in a daily habit.

Platform	Publishing + Pay	Open Protocol	Source Ratings	Deliberation	Civic Action	Verified Constituents
Substack / Beehiiv / Ghost	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No
Pol.is / Make.org	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No
CivicSky	✓ Yes	✓ Both	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes

Business Model and Cost Discipline

Revenue Streams

Membership

\$5/month — badges, commenting, and verification included.
Author revenue share at **5%**, half of Substack's 10%.

District Verification

\$10/year for free users — cost recovery plus bot defense.
Included with membership.

Official Accounts

\$100/month per district, activated at 1,000+ verified constituents. Tools only — never paid reach or ranking.

Cost Architecture

Meta spends approximately **\$0.85 per daily user per month**. Our target:
\$0.10 per monthly active user.

How we get there: text-first product, no ads, no surveillance ranking, community-scoped indexing, cached reads, web checkout instead of app stores.

Projections — Accelerated Case

Conversion rate is the key variable. The conservative case assumes slower growth and approximately 3% conversion. **Mastodon reached 70,000 users in 60 days** with no election, no marketing, and no creator economy. CivicSky launches into a presidential cycle with all three.

Year	Total Users	Paid (Conv. Rate)	Membership	Author 5%	Officials	Total Revenue
2029	1.5M	60K (4%)	\$3.60M	\$302K	\$180K	\$4.08M
2030	2.5M	125K (5%)	\$7.50M	\$630K	\$600K	\$8.73M
2031	3.5M	175K (5%)	\$10.50M	\$882K	\$1.20M	\$12.58M
2032	4.5M	225K (5%)	\$13.50M	\$1.13M	\$1.80M	\$16.43M

Mission Lock and How Investors Get Paid

Structure

CivicSky PBC operates the platform. **Civic Works 501(c)(3)** holds the IP under a long-term license with a capped royalty — terminable only for mission breach.

A golden share holds narrow veto over sale, mission, and license only. Voting control moves to a **perpetual purpose trust** over time.

Instrument

Convertible note — 6–8% interest, 48-month maturity, valuation cap plus 15–20% discount. Return caps: **4x first close; 2.5–3x second tranche.**

Three Paths to Liquidity

1

Priced Round

Notes convert at the cap.

2

Redemption

70% of free cash flow until the cap is met.

3

Buyout

At the purpose trust transition.

Roadmap and Team



Build Model

Founders plus AI for the prototype. Contractors for beta. Blended team for production — all triggered by milestones, not a fixed burn.

Team

George A. Polisner — Founder

Technology leadership at Oracle, HP, and Dell. California state government. Civic organizing. Deliberative democracy research.

Golda Velez — CTO

Golda has provided expertise at JPL, Oracle, and other major enterprises and startups to direct complex projects, programs, and teams.

The Ask

First Close — \$850K

Convertible notes. Funds a 12-month contract-built beta: **55%** engineering, **15%** founder and operations, **14%** author acquisition, **10%** legal and security, **6%** infrastructure.

Second Tranche — \$2.0–2.5M

Committed up front, released on milestones (target June 2027): federation and payouts live; 25+ paying authors; 300+ paid subscribers; 3,000 monthly active users.

Why Now

The 2024 federal election cost over **\$15.9 billion**. Our entire raise is less than four hours of that spending — for civic infrastructure that outlasts any election and pays investors back.

We report retention, conversion, and cost per active user by cohort from beta onward. No vanity metrics.

Civic infrastructure that cannot be sold to be subverted.

George Polisner | civicsky.civ.works | george@civ.works